

the eagle's eye

VOLUME 3 ISSUE 1 | 2021

**CREATED & PUBLISHED BY THE
LEADERS OF ENGLISH PROGRAMME**

-UNITY SECONDARY SCHOOL



FOREWORD

Hey everyone! Woah, it's my second time issuing a foreword in The Eagle's Eye as the Head Editor, but I'm sad to say that... this will be my last.

On a lighter note, it has been a joy to provide the school with a little bit of students' insights on issues that matter to us, or simply ones that interest us! And I hope that, in any capacity, all you fellow Unitians enjoy taking in the work we put out. After all, that's what we want to do: give our students a voice - a platform to express and impress. We sincerely hope that this new edition of The Eagle's Eye will prove a good read for you, take your mind off stress for a bit as you revel inside a little of what the world and our society has to offer... through the English language! Hopefully, these articles will inspire you, too, to cultivate a love for the art of language -- my greatest wish. That's it from me for now... happy reading!

XOXO, Kristy

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Trendy Terms Teachers Should Know!

By Tanya (2E2) & Harinie (2E2)

Many teachers these days may have heard of these trendy terms, but not the exact meanings behind them. The younger generation has been using terms like "sus", "no cap" and many more. Let's take a look at some of them today!

LIT

THIS TRENDY TERM IS USUALLY USED TO DESCRIBE SOMETHING VERY COOL OR PERCEIVED AS AWE-INSPIRING.

"DUDE, I SWEAR THAT PLACE IS LIT!"

"THAT VIDEO GAME I BOUGHT LAST WEEK IS LIT."



LOWKEY..

LOWKEY IS TYPICALLY USED TO DESCRIBE SOMETHING THAT IS NOT VERY OBVIOUS AND BLATANT. IT CAN ALSO INDICATE SOMETHING THAT IS SECRETLY (PERHAPS SOMEWHAT SHAMEFULLY) WANTED OR FELT BY THE SPEAKER.

"I LOWKEY HATE JEN EVEN THOUGH SHE HAS DONE NOTHING PERSONALLY BAD TO ME."

"I LOWKEY LOVE TO HUG MY TEDDY BEAR TO SLEEP EVEN THOUGH I'M THIRTEEN."



SUS

THIS IS OFTEN USED AS A SHORT FORM OF SUSPICION.

"HE'S BEEN ACTING SO SUS LATELY..."

"THERE'S SOMETHING SUS ABOUT THIS WHOLE SITUATION..."



NO CAP!

IT'S OFTEN USED TO EMPHASIZE SOMEONE IS NOT EXAGGERATING ABOUT THE TRUTH ON SOCIAL MEDIA PLATFORMS SUCH AS TWITTER AND TIKTOK, YOU'LL OFTEN COME ACROSS USERS POSTING COMMENTS SUCH AS "'NO "'.

"I'M SO TIRED I'M GOING TO SLEEP TILL MONDAY. NO CAP."

"MY MOM BOUGHT ME A ROLEX WATCH YESTERDAY. NO CAP."

MOVIE/TV BITES *By Adhav (2E2)*



THE EVOLUTION OF STREAMING WARS

Back in 2018, the number of streaming services were limited. The only popular ones were Netflix, Hulu and Amazon Prime Video. However since 2020, this changed. Now, we have a much wider variety of streaming services worldwide to choose from. These streaming services include Paramount+ by ViacomCBS, HBO Max by Warner Media, Peacock by Comcast, Apple TV+ by Apple and Disney Plus by the Walt Disney Company.

The reason why many popular companies create streaming services for themselves is to create a platform to store movies and shows to be distributed by the respective companies. This will enable subscribers to view them anytime and anywhere, providing them with great convenience.

Now that there is a wide selection of streaming services to choose from, there is inevitable competition between them as they battle for viewership. The competition between these streaming services is known as streaming wars. The streaming service currently winning the war is Disney+. Disney+ managed to obtain a hundred million subscribers in less than 2 years of its release, a number Netflix took 9 years to reach, even though they are one of the first streaming services to ever exist. The reason as to why this is most likely due to the boost from the pandemic and the quantity of family-friendly content on the service which prompts viewers to consume more media.

In order to compete with the success of Disney Plus, the company Warner Bros has initiated a plan where they release films distributed by themselves in theatres and on HBO Max at the same time with no extra price and Netflix has decided to release a film with an A-List actor every week.

With the increase in viewers preferring to watch media in the comfort of their homes, we can expect further developments and increasing numbers of streaming platforms.

2021 Major Film Release Schedule

Scan the QR code to see some of the major films coming soon this year!



Movie	Release	Distributed by
Cruella	27th May	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Luca	18th June	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
F9	25th June	Universal
Black Widow	9th July	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Space Jam	16th July	Warner Bros.
The Suicide Squad	6th Aug.	Warner Bros.
Shang-Chi	3rd Sept.	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Dune	1st Oct.	Warner Bros.
Spider-Man	17th Dec.	Sony



Deepfake Technology

By Adhav (2E2)

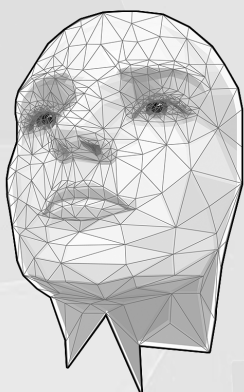
What Are Deepfakes?

Deepfakes are synthetic media in which a person in an existing image or video is replaced with someone else's likeness.

Deepfake technology is often being manipulated in an unfair manner in order to people into thinking that someone has said something controversial. This can lead to the opinions of a person changing.

How are Deepfakes made?

Thousands of face shots of two people are running through an Artificial Intelligence algorithm called an encoder. Then, the encoder spots the similarities of the face shots and compresses them to their same common features. There are other ways as to how deepfakes are being made but the use of an encoder is the most popular.



Deepfakes that are of poor quality are easier to spot. Although, it is harder to spot deepfakes made by professionals. According to US researchers, the majority of deepfake videos show that the individuals in those videos do not blink normally. But as soon as the research was published, the people who made deepfakes improved their technology and were able to make the deepfakes blink.

Deepfakes have the unwanted potential to create an untrusting society. It is harder to trust everything you see on the internet nowadays due to more of such technologies.

In my opinion, deepfake technology should not be abused by people to create counterfeit videos and it should be used for a greater cause instead. Educators can use this form of art to help deliver lessons that are far more engaging for students. The use of the AI-Generated synthetic media can help to appropriate real events comedically to make it more interesting. It can help give journalists that wish to remain anonymous a method to voice themselves out through avatars created by deepfake technology.

Deepfakes can be used as a great tool to enact change in our lives. It is able to give people purpose, a voice and the ability to influence others. The use of such powerful technology should not fall into the wrong hands, as there would be a lot of exploitation for personal gains.

GAME ON!; VALORANT

By Elfie (3E4) & Cherise (2E2)

Valorant, a video game developed by Riot Games, the same team responsible for the all-time classic "League of Legends", is a competitive game that offers a 5v5 first-person-shooter gameplay. It was released in early June 2020 and has been a big hit since then, so much so that it made it into the top five list of the most popular streamed games on Twitch in 2020! The game is constantly updated with new content, so players do not have to worry about getting bored of it.

All of the characters in Valorant follow a four ability structure, but beyond their primary ability that is usable on a round by round basis, two to three of their abilities will be purchasable at the start of a round and their ultimate is dependent on the amount of kills or wins they get per round, with one charge each.

"Generally, this game is all about timing and crosshair placement. Since we have limited time to kill, the precision needed to aim for the head is very high and can be pressuring at times."

This game involves multiple characters/ agents with a wide variety of skill sets. Personally, my favourite agent is Reyna as she is a duelist and can easily escape from situations in which she could kill



opponents. Reyna has 4 abilities, which are: blind, dismiss, heal and her ultimate. A duelist is supposed to entry for the team as they are able to get the kills.

Here is a more in depth explanation on Reyna's skills: she has 2 blinds, so if the enemy were to have direct eye contact with Reyna's ability which spawns an eye, they get blinded, so it is easily to kill them. The downside is that the flash can be broken.

Moreover, whenever Reyna kills an enemy, they'll drop a soul orb in which she only has 3 seconds to pick up. Once enough orbs are collected, she can activate one (out of two) basic abilities which are dismiss or heal. Her ultimate allows her to increase her fire rate and possess unlimited dismiss. If she kills an enemy while her ultimate is active, she will instantly heal. On top of that, there will be a soul orb that she can use which allows her to stay invisible for a short period of time.

Overall, Reyna is a fun and skillful character to use and she makes every game played worthwhile."

- Chad



Millions of people around the world, including people in our own school, enjoy playing Valorant. Despite the possibly toxic community leading to certain inappropriate behaviour displayed by some players, many people greatly enjoy playing the game. Valorant is definitely worthy of its title as one of the most frequently streamed games on Twitch in the year 2020.



ART - and Why it Matters!

By Kristy (4E4) & Emily (3E4)

What comes to mind when we think of the term 'art'? Our minds spiral into imaginations of drawings, sketches, paintings, sculptures, and the like. However, we often fail to recognize that art is not merely a visual craft - it is so much more beyond solely the visual; it is everywhere around us! Be it in the songs we press repeat on, the fiction we indulge in, the dances we weave our bodies to, the fine landmarks we gaze in awe at. See, art is a definite staple of sorts in our lives. Although, even with that said, why is it that apathy for the arts is not uncommon in our student population?

With art being such a quintessential component in our lives, it is no surprise that the visual arts are prevalent within our academic spheres - it is a well-known fact that Art is an examinable subject in many schools.



However, it is also known that many of us turn to the subject with contempt or dread on our faces. Perhaps, a few reasons for this could stem from a matter of us students' many, differing interests. It is only natural to have natural affinities, such as one for sports, for the sciences, or the languages. Alternatively, it could be due to the rigid structure of art examinations in school - two or three hours given to procure a whole canvas of work, with a mountain of coursework leading up to it. Even so, through the dread, we should not take the visual arts merely at face its value.

As to why art is everywhere around us, it is a good time to define the universal term 'art'. According to the Cambridge Dictionary, it means "the making of objects, images, music, etc. that are beautiful or that express feeling(s)". Think of our school's mascot, representing a spirit of R²ECIPE, for instance - the intricacies in the eagle's wings perched above our hall's stage, the paint works on it. Alternatively, of our school's architecture - someone must have designed the paths we take to classes to this day. Or, the school song we hear every Monday - a pioneer student must have composed it with his heart.

Apart from a school context, even things like the books we binge on, the shows we stream on our devices, and even the clothes we flaunt while outside - are products of creative expressions. Some examples are Flowers in Blossom by Tay Chee Toh at Marina Bay, Leaves by Jason Lim at Downtown and so many more. Art, as such, is present in our memories and lives. What would we be without art?

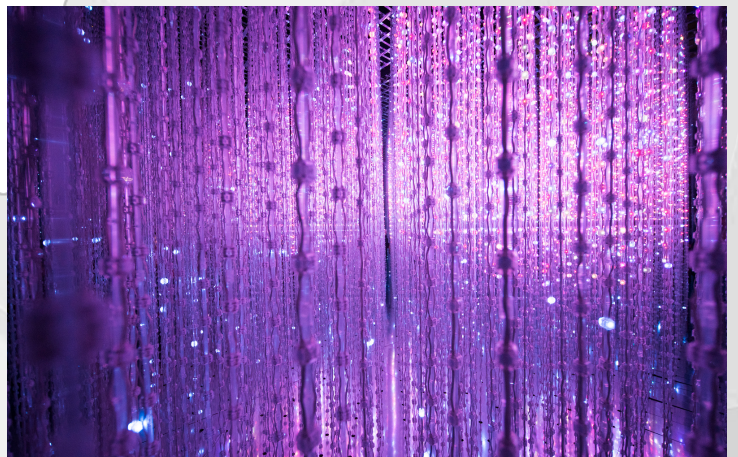
So, how else does art play a role in our lives? Well, since the nature of art lies in human emotion and thus expression, most of us can express our emotions based on our everyday lives; remember the feelings we have right on the spot and then turn it into memorable paintings or pictures on paper from our head. With how freeing it is to let out our emotions and imagination, it is no wonder why there exist people who find solace in the arts. However, there are of course people who prefer seeking comfort in technicalities like solving puzzles, arranging things in order, so on and so forth.



Nonetheless, we should all respect these different areas of life and their aid in our lives. It is important that we explore perspectives, normalising these harmless interests, creations and coping mechanisms. There, too, is an art in opening up our hearts to empathise with our peers - it is an expression of emotion.

In the bigger picture, we hold the belief that we should not be discouraged from pursuing careers in the art and creativity sector - the beauty of life lies in passion and achieving our dreams, feeling emotions to the best of our ability and translating this into everything we do. As such, with this expression of emotion, everything can subjectively be a work of art.

In conclusion, without 'art', our world would just be monochromatic and void of expression and personality. So, if you have a passion or flair for the arts and anything else, don't be afraid to chase after your dreams and conquer them, the world will be a brighter place filled with more love, emotions and colours.



DEVICE MANAGEMENT APPLICATION – PDPL TEACHER'S & STUDENT'S PERSPECTIVE [INTERVIEW]



By Rithika (3E2), Yu Huan (2E2) & Ives (2E3)

As I'm sure we have all heard, there has been quite a big controversy going around concerning the Device Management Application (DMA) that will be installed into every students' Personal Learning Device (PLD). Thus, we have conducted an anonymous interview to gather our students' and teachers' thoughts on the DMA. Here are the responses we've gathered.



INTERVIEWEES:

Q1

What are your thoughts on the DMA that will be implemented into our Personal Learning Devices?

Z: I think it has its pros and cons. It helps to prevent us from logging into apps and playing during lessons, allowing us to give our fullest attention in class. This assists our self-directed learning, allowing them to study effectively even on a device. Furthermore, since using devices in school to learn is new to us, it's better to keep us in a zone where we won't distract ourselves by surfing other websites. However, we'll feel too restricted, being unable to use PLDs for personal interests other than studying. We'll feel as if they paid for it just to study, to their frustration. Moreover, we'll find the devices rather useless and start to abandon it since we have our own devices that can be used for many purposes. Overall, it will certainly assist our learning in a whole new way. We'll be more focused in class and not misuse our PLDs, as long as we are aware of DMA's purpose, it will surely benefit our learning.

C: I think this will benefit both students and teachers because it prevents students from accessing websites that we aren't supposed to, like social media sites. For instance, if we surf websites that are suspicious, there's a chance that the PLD would get a virus, messing the system up.

ML: Of course, teachers will prefer DMA to be installed on the device so that we can control unauthorised usage during lesson time, to prevent some irresponsible students from doing other things instead of focusing on their learning

Q2

How do you think the DMA will affect yourself, your teachers and students?

E: I feel like it wouldn't really affect me, as I feel like it is a necessary step for a more conducive learning environment, and the teachers will benefit greatly, as the chances of students going to other sites is greatly reduced.

S: However, doing so does not instil in students values such as integrity and responsibility in handling the devices. Secondly, I think that we should be responsible for our own devices and the way we use them.

C: Teachers will be able to teach better in the sense that pupils wouldn't be distracted in class and pay attention. Personally, I think that the majority of students will dislike DMA because we cannot play games and browse the web in class. My classmates tell me that they will feel bored in class. Being bored in class is the main reason why they go onto other websites to play video games or browse the web thus getting distracted.

Q3

How do you think the DMA can be further improved so that the students can study in the best learning environment possible?

Z: I think DMA can be further improved by allowing it to be only applied during school, but to be removed when they reach home. With that, students can still use the devices at home freely based on their interests instead of being purely restricted to studying only so that they can make full use of the devices even when they are not using them for learning.

C: The teachers could control the DMA through a lock system so that students can log onto websites to research a presentation. Some websites may be locked because of it and teachers can just easily unlock the system and allow students to gain access to certain websites and not have problems where a student cannot access the website on their own.

ML: As I know, MOE is going to roll out a new policy to allow parents to unlock the DMA at home, so I think this will be good news to the students.

E: I think the DMA should push to promote better learning habits while discouraging bad ones to encourage students to follow suit.

S: Thus, I personally think that the DMA plan can be improved by implementing it for some time and once the students' history has been monitored and states that students are on track in work, the Ministry of Education can remove the DMA.



Support the
Development of Digital
Literacies



Support self-directed and
collaborative learning



Enhance Teaching and
Learning

Editor's Note: The research and plan to write this article came about due to an uproar online about the implementation of this software somewhere in the early part of the year when the plan was announced. TEE has since learnt that while DMA is a default app that controls how the Chromebooks are used, flexibility and the decision to use the app is given to parents to decide for their child. Let's all use this opportunity to maximize this tool for our learning and growth!

ALL TUNED IN



We have all been there - you're at home and you just can't seem to stop humming a tune you heard somewhere or you're doing homework and need the company of sound. Whether you like it or not, music has played a role in your life one way or another. It could be casually humming a tune you heard in the supermarket that you just can't get out of your head or singing the same nursery rhymes as children. Music has been a constant in joining people together but people rarely take time to appreciate this uniquely human gift.

Through the years music has gone through many transformations from the prominence of Jazz and Swing in the 20s, all the way to the rise of Rock in the 50s. The changes that music goes through usually reflect the period that they occur in. Genres like Rap are synonymous with the African American community as it was created as a way to fight back oppression and find an identity. These genres gain a following as they resonate with many people and act as a way to express themselves and find comfort in trying times.

Fast forward to today and music still plays this same role. Music has reached an interesting point in time as it is a sort of a transitional period as oldies exit and rookies enter the scene. This has set the ground for a diverse mix of genres. Genres that have previously been overlooked by the masses have also gained traction with the help of social media platforms like Tiktok. Various artists have intelligently leveraged this to try various styles of music leading to some interesting hybrids and blends of sounds. Let's take a look at some of the music that was wildly popular in the past year.

Daily Top 100



Also just as a pre amble OPINIONS are going to be voiced out in the next few paragraphs. I repeat OPINIONS that may or may not differ from your own. Reader discretion is advised.



OVERALL : 8/10
CIRCLES

In a year of chaos and unexpected events, this album calmed my senses and gave me hot cocoa all while saying "Hey it's gonna be okay, bro".

The laidback and personal touch that Mac has graced with his music gives us a truly intimate experience. This posthumous album was a tasteful window to his life and provides with us a good conclusion to a career that was cut short to drugs. A reminder of how short life truly is and how we need to make the most even out of all the negativity.



OVERALL : 7/10
NECTAR

Joji is known for his music which is laced with melancholy all while being catchy and a definite earworm for many.

A courageous artist who has proved that ballads have a place in modern music, Nectar truly solidifies his signature moodiness and dark aesthetic while allowing for a diverse mix of styles that keep you entertained throughout the album. There's something for everyone to enjoy in this album and tracks like "Run" give us a glimpse of what he is capable of and what else his career has to offer.